

Calculator

The calculator NDA (Figure 8B) is a simple four-banger that can be operated with the mouse or via the IIGS numeric keypad (notice that the calculator's on-screen layout is the same as the numeric keypad's physical layout; the asterisk, "*" is used for multiplication and the slash, "/" is used for division). The calculator doesn't understand precedence—it performs all operations in the order you choose them. (If you're used to algebraic calculators where multiplication and division are always performed before addition and subtraction, well, this one isn't quite that sophisticated. The System 6 Bonus pack includes a scientific calculator that's quite a bit more powerful, though.)

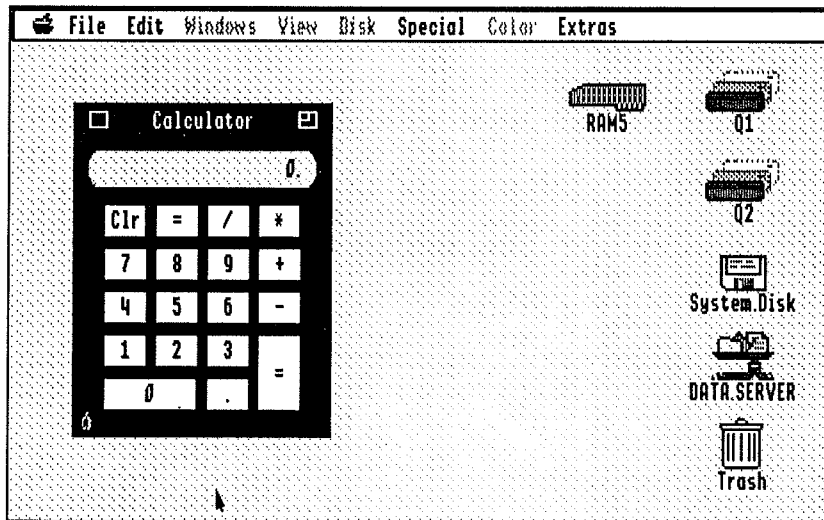


Figure 8B—The System 6 Calculator

▲ By The Way...

Clicking the Calculator's zoom box (upper right corner of its window) or pressing the 'Z' key expands the calculator's keypad to include a hexadecimal keypad. Click the "Hex" button to switch the calculator to hexadecimal mode. (You programmers will know what that is—it's next to useless for ordinary mortals, though.) Pressing the 'H' key toggles the calculator between hexadecimal and decimal mode. The calculator's hexadecimal keypad does not need to be visible to be used.

➡ Shortcut

Use the "=" key to repeat the last operation. For example, to count upward by odd numbers, type "1 + 2 = = = =." Typing "/" followed by "=" calculates the reciprocal of the number in the display (same as dividing it into 1). For example, "4 / =" yields 0.25.